



A mural from Daria Daulat Bagh, the summer palace belonging to Tipu Sultan, ruler of the southwestern Indian kingdom of Mysore from 1782–99.

AS BRITAIN'S EAST INDIA

COMPANY attempted to extend its reach outside of Bengal, it often met resistance from Indian princely states. This was especially true of the southwestern kingdom of Mysore, which was under the rule of the powerful **Haidar Ali Khan** (1722–82). Disputes over territory and had led to the First Mysore War (1767–69), which was soon followed by the **Second Mysore War** (1780–84). The fighting did not completely settle the conflict between them, which continued until 1799.

Unrest in India was not the only military preoccupation for Britain, which was now fighting on many fronts. In addition to the ongoing war in North America, dispute broke out with the Dutch. The **Fourth Anglo–Dutch War** (1780–84), which saw no actual fighting, was a direct consequence of the conflict in America. The Dutch were supplying arms to the rebelling colonists, and a dispute erupted over Britain's seizure of Dutch ships. The

Dutch maintained Britain should respect their neutrality, but the British did not agree.

The North American colonists were not alone in their struggle, as their southern neighbors in Peru took up arms in the **Túpac Amaru revolt** (1780–82), which was prompted by dissatisfaction with the Spanish colonial regime. Some 75,000 Indians and Creoles (those born in Peru but of Spanish descent) rose up in protest at their treatment. The leader Túpac Amaru II (see box, below) was captured and killed in 1781, but it took another year and 60,000 Spanish troops to quell the unrest.

In Africa, the kingdom of **Buganda**, located on the northern shore of Lake Ukerewe (Lake Victoria), emerged as a regional power as it expanded its territory. Around the same time, the **Masai**, who occupied the southeastern side of the lake, were also becoming a significant presence in the region and were moving farther south and east—helped by their large, organized warrior class.

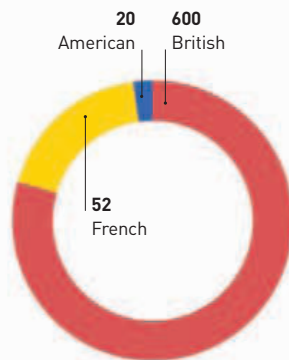
TUPAC AMARU II (c. 1742–81)

Born José Gabriel Condorcanqui in Cuzco, Peru, around 1742, Túpac Amaru II renamed himself after the last Inca leader, who ruled the Incan Empire from 1545–72. Of *mestizo* (Indian and Spanish) heritage, he fought against the colonial regime to gain better conditions for the indigenous population of Peru.



Lord Cornwallis, left, surrenders his sword to George Washington, right, after the British defeat at the Battle of Yorktown.

THE ONGOING WAR between Britain and North American colonists took a decisive turn at the battle of **Yorktown**, Virginia, on October 19. The **Continental Army** had received a boost from French support the previous year, and the **Comte de Rochambeau** (1725–1807) led troops alongside the American **General George Washington** (1732–99). Their combined force of ground soldiers meant that when rebel forces took



Deaths at the Battle of Yorktown
Yorktown took a high toll on British troops and proved decisive in the quest to end British rule in America.

their positions on September 28 **General Charles Cornwallis** (1738–1805) was outnumbered by more than two to one, and his reinforcements failed to arrive in time. That, along with a French naval blockade, gave Cornwallis no option but to surrender. Although this was the last major battle of the **Revolutionary War**, official recognition of American independence would not come until later.

The politics of the American colonies was changing. The **Articles of Confederation** had been ratified earlier in the year, on March 1. The process of ratification had started in 1777 under the **Second Continental Congress**. The agreement set up a “firm league of friendship” for what were to be known as the **United States of America**, while outlining what the responsibilities of the central government would be. The document would eventually be replaced with the US Constitution (see 1787).

In Europe, tensions between the Dutch and British led to a convoy of British ships setting off from India on August 9 with orders to destroy Dutch settlements in **Sumatra**. When the British arrived, the small Dutch population in the outposts surrendered immediately and all the Dutch factories and warehouses in **Padang** were turned over to the British crown.

Meanwhile, colonial subjects in the **Viceroyalty of New Granada**—which comprised present-day Colombia, Venezuela, Panama, and Ecuador—were discontent with the Spanish regime. They revolted over mounting taxes on tobacco and



American rifleman

This cartoon depicts an American rifleman as worn out and badly equipped. However, these soldiers defeated British regular troops.

alcohol in what became known as the **Comunero Rebellion**. Plans to march on Bogotá were abandoned after a deal was reached over taxes but the Spanish viceroy then attacked the *comuneros* and killed two of their leaders.

Revolution of an intellectual kind was taking place in Prussia with the publication of the *Critique of Pure Reason* by the philosopher **Immanuel Kant** (1724–1804). His work challenged existing notions about the nature of knowledge.

“ **SCIENCE IS ORGANIZED KNOWLEDGE. WISDOM IS ORGANIZED LIFE.** ”

Immanuel Kant, German philosopher, from *Critique of Pure Reason*, 1781

Second Anglo–Mysore War triggered over the Nawab of Arcot's debt payments (to 1784)

Buganda emerges as major power in Central Africa

English language Bengal Gazette first published

Túpac Amaru leads indigenous rebellion in Peru (to 1781)

British declare war on the Dutch (to 1784) for supplying French and Spanish arms to American troops

Holy Roman Emperor Joseph II extends full legal freedom to serfs

March Comuneros rebel over tax rises in New Granada (Colombia)

March 13 Astronomer William Herschel discovers Uranus

August British take Dutch settlements on the west coast of Sumatra

October 19 General George Washington defeats British at Yorktown

German philosopher Immanuel Kant (1724–1804) publishes his *Critique of Pure Reason*